High School Musical, The Birthday: The Musical

[East High School steps]

(A gathering of students is doing a pep rally)

CHAD

C'mon Wildcats!

ALL

WILDCATS, SING ALONG
YEAH, YOU REALLY GOT IT GOIN' ON
WILDCATS IN THE HOUSE
EVERYBODY SAY IT NOW

(Students run in, wave to each other, find friends and join the cheer)

WILDCATS EVERYWHERE
WAVE YOUR HANDS UP IN THE AIR
THAT'S THE WAY WE DO IT
LET'S GET TO IT
TIME TO SHOW THE WORLD

(Chad flags down Troy; The jocks, including Zeke fall into place behind their leader)

CHAD

Yo doggie! Troy my hoops boy!

TROY

Hey Chad. Dudes…. Happy New Year.

CHAD

(imitating preacher)
Oh yes, my brothers, it will be a Happy Wildcat New Year, because this Friday we play the league championship game with you, Mr. Troy Bolton, leading us to infinity and beyond!

JOCKS

Hallelujah!!

ALL

WILDCATS, SING ALONG
YEAH, YOU REALLY GOT IT GOIN' ON
WILDCATS IN THE HOUSE
EVERYBODY SAY IT NOW

(Sharpay and Ryan enter)

ZEKE

(oggling Sharpay)
Guys, here she comes. Man, she's gorgeous.

CHAD
Hey, the ice princess has returned from the North Pole.

ZEKE
(finding the nerve to address Sharpay)
Hi, uhm, you know, I mean, hi Sharpay, how are —

(Without even glancing at Zeke, Sharpay blows past him)

RYAN
(wanting to be friendly)
Hi Troy. Getting ready for the big game?

(Sharpay pushes Ryan out of the way so she has a clear path to Troy)

SHARPAY
(with a calculated flip of her hair, wistfully)
Hi, Troy.

TROY
(couldn't be less interested)
Hi, Sharpay.

(Sharpay and Ryan walk away. Chad leads the guys to join in on the school cheer)

ALL
WILDCATS EVERYWHERE
WAVE YOUR HANDS UP IN THE AIR
THAT'S THE WAY WE DO IT
LET'S GET TO IT
TIME TO SHOW THE WORLD

(Lost in the crowd is Gabriella. Taylor arrives with Martha, and eyeballs Chad and the jocks)

TAYLOR
Ah, behold the zoo animals heralding the New Year. How tribal.

SHARPAY
They were heralding my entrance, dear.

TAYLOR
La Diva speaks! So what did you do over break, Sharpay, your nails or your scales?

(Sharpay sings to the students, and content that she impressed her audience, turns away from them)

(TAYLOR)
Scales. Just like all the other snakes.

(Gabriella laughs with Taylor at the joke, and bumps into Kelsi)

ALL

WILDCATS EVERYWHERE
WAVE YOUR HANDS UP IN THE AIR
THAT'S THE WAY WE DO IT
LET'S GET TO IT
C'MON EVERYONE

TAYLOR

(extending her hand to Gabriella)
Hi, I'm Taylor McKessie. You must be new.

GABRIELLA

Gabriella Montez. Hi. Yeah, my mom just got transferred for work… Again.

TAYLOR

Welcome! Moving can be such a drag. Did you at least do something fun over the winter break?

GABRIELLA

Oh, you know… my mom took me on a ski trip. All I did was read.

TAYLOR

(excitedly)
Excellent, another bookworm!

SHARPAY

(butting into the conversation)
With all those cute boys on the slopes? Why do you think Prada makes all that fabulous après ski wear?

(fingers form an "L" on her forehead)

LOSER!

GABRIELLA

(timidly)
Well, uhm, actually I *did* meet a boy.

TAYLOR

See? So make with the newsflash, sister! I'm all ears.

(cut to Troy regales his friends with stories of his winter break)

(Gabriella and Troy face offstage away from each other, with Troy facing towards the group of guy students and Gabriella facing towards the group of girl students)

TROY

(addressing the guys)
It was the *best*trip. The slopes were perfect! And I met the hottest little snow bunny ever!

GABRIELLA

(addressing the girls)
You'll never guess how I met him.

(During the next few lines, Gabriella and Troy are backed towards each other by their friend groups as they are pressed for further details)

CHAD

How'd you meet her?

TAYLOR

Snowboarding?

TROY

Snowboarding.

GABRIELLA

Singing! He was pretty good, too!

TROY

Man, she was so hot, the slopes turned to slush.

CHAD

(to the guys)
Yeah, so did Troy.

TAYLOR

Singing?

GABRIELLA

They threw a contest for the kids. It was kind of romantic, you know?

M.C (V.O.)

Can you say, "karaoke"?!!

ALL

Karaoke!!

[Ski lodge]

(Students shuffle around to play Party Kids at the ski lodge, Troy and Gabriella stay facing away from each other)

(Troy and Gabriella look like deer in the headlights, terrified of making fools of themselves. Still not seeing each other, they reluctantly step forward to sing. They both slowly back up until they bump into each other. They turn and stare into each other's eyes. Love at first sight.)

TROY

I'm Troy. I can't sing.

GABRIELLA

Gabriella. Me either.

TROY

They're all looking at us.

GABRIELLA

I will if you will.

(both are shy to start the song, the crowd of kids are uninterested)

TROY

LIVING IN MY OWN WORLD
DIDN'T UNDERSTAND
THAT ANYTHING CAN HAPPEN
WHEN YOU TAKE A CHANCE

(Troy starts to turn and walk away flustered at the embarrassment of singing alone, but is stunned by Gabriella's singing and returns)

GABRIELLA

I NEVER BELIEVED IN
WHAT I COULDN'T SEE
I NEVER OPENED MY HEART
TO ALL THE POSSIBILITIES

TROY, GABRIELLA

OH I KNOW
THAT SOMETHING HAS CHANGED
NEVER FELT THIS WAY

GABRIELLA

AND RIGHT HERE TONIGHT

TROY, GABRIELLA

THIS COULD BE THE START
OF SOMETHING NEW
IT FEELS SO RIGHT
TO BE HERE WITH YOU, OH
AND NOW LOOKIN' IN YOUR EYES
I FEEL IN MY HEART
THE START OF SOMETHING NEW

(Troy and Gabriella loosen up and the crowd starts to show their support)

TROY, GABRIELLA
NOW WHO'D HAVE EVER THOUGHT THAT
WE'D BOTH BE HERE TONIGHT
AND THE WORLD LOOKS SO MUCH BRIGHTER
WITH YOU BY MY SIDE
OH I KNOW
THAT SOMETHING HAS CHANGED
NEVER FELT THIS WAY

GABRIELLA
I KNOW IT FOR REAL

TROY, GABRIELLA
THIS COULD BE THE START
OF SOMETHING NEW
IT FEELS SO RIGHT
TO BE HERE WITH YOU, OH
AND NOW LOOKING IN YOUR EYES
I FEEL IN MY HEART
THE START OF SOMETHING NEW

TROY
I NEVER KNEW THAT IT COULD HAPPEN
TILL IT HAPPENED TO ME, OH YEAH

GABRIELLA
I DIDN'T KNOW IT BEFORE
BUT NOW IT'S EASY TO SEE, OH

TROY, GABRIELLA
(key change one step up)
(Troy and Gabriella are facing each other while singing the rest of the song)

IT'S THE START
OF SOMETHING NEW
IT FEELS SO RIGHT
TO BE HERE WITH YOU, OH
AND NOW LOOKING IN YOUR EYES
I FEEL IN MY HEART
THAT IT'S THE START
OF SOMETHING NEW
IT FEELS SO RIGHT
TO BE HERE WITH YOU, OH
AND NOW LOOKING IN YOUR EYES
I FEEL IN MY HEART
THE START OF SOMETHING NEW

TROY
THE START OF SOMETHING NEW

TROY, GABRIELLA
THE START OF SOMETHING NEW

(Troy and Gabriella are happily stunned at how good they feel singing with each other)

(stepping to the side while conversing)

TROY
Seriously, you have an amazing voice. You're a singer, right?

GABRIELLA
Just church choir, is all. I tried a solo and nearly fainted.

TROY
Really? Why's that?

GABRIELLA
I took a look at all the people staring at me *(gestures to audience)* and next thing I knew I was staring at the ceiling. End of solo career.

TROY
Well, with the way you sang tonight, that's pretty hard to believe.

GABRIELLA
That was the first time I've done something like that. I mean, it was so cool.

TROY
I know. Completely.

GABRIELLA
You sounded like you've done a lot of singing too.

TROY
Yeah, well my shower head is very impressed with it.

PARTY KIDS
10!, 9! …

(Troy and Gabriella glance at each other awkwardly as the countdown finishes, neither wanting to make the first move)

PARTY KIDS
… 3! 2! 1! Happy New Year!!

GABRIELLA
I guess I'd better go find my mom and wish her a happy New Year.

TROY
Yeah, me too. I mean, not *your* mom. My mom… and dad.

Uh, I'll call you. I'll call you tomorrow! Here, put your number in.

(Troy and Gabriella exchange numbers)

(Troy grins at his phone and turns away, Gabriella disappears into the crowd while he monologues)

Well, just so you know, singing with you has been the most fun I've had this entire vacation. So, uhm, where do you live--

(Troy looks around and sees that Gabriella is missing, lets out a sigh and looks back at his phone)

Gabriella...

(flashback ends, party kids shuffle around back to students at East High School)

(Troy turns to Chad and the jocks, Gabriella to Taylor and the Brainiacs)

TROY

It was awesome!

GABRIELLA

It was like a dream.

[Ms. Darbus homeroom]

(Troy and Gabriella are among the last to sit. He catches a glimpse of her, but can't believe his eyes. She sits in the back of the class. Before Troy can take another look, Ms. Darbus enters her homeroom with a grand flourish. She is eccentric, fueled by a genuine love of theatre and teaching.)

MS. DARBUS

(reciting with simple clarity, emotive)
"But soft! What light through yonder window breaks? It is the east, and Juliet is the sun. Arise, fair sun, and kill the envious moon, Who is already sick and pale with grief, That thou her maid art far more fair than she."

(she waits for approval from the class. Sharpay, Ryan and Kelsi applaud enthusiastically)

Thank you… thank you very much. Well, once again, they forgot to announce the auditions for the winter musical, Juliet and Romeo, written by our very own Kelsi Neilson. Kelsi, stand up and take a bow.

(Kelsi sinks lower and hides her face behind a book. One hand rises tentatively to accept the mild applause from the class)

(Ms. Darbus continues)
It's a delicious neo-feminist adaptation of Shakespeare's classic tragedy of star-crossed lovers… with THREE — count 'em THREE — tap numbers! By thinking outside the box, Kelsi has brilliantly swapped out a tragic ending with a happy ending, in which the two lovers both live… and move to Albequerque! IT's simply bursting with sword fights, meddling parents and teenagers caught in the grip of forbidden love. If you kids can't relate to *that*, I'll eat my hat. Now there'll be single auditions for the supporting roles and chorus, as well as pairs auditions for our two leads.

(Chad and the jocks snort and giggle at the idea of participating in a musical)

(Ms. Darbus to Chad)
Mr. Danforth, this is a place of learning, not a hockey-ball court. Save your bilabial fricatives for someone of your own primitive aesthetic.

(Troy sneakily takes his phone out and tries to text without being noticed by the teacher)

This year, as always, the Drama Club faces a dearth of male participants, so please come in and audition. I'm offering you the chance to spread your wings into bold new horizons. I'm offering you the timeless allure of the greasepaint, the magical power of the Klieg light!
(Ms. Darbus notices no one is paying attention)
All right! … I'm offering you extra credit.

(A cell phone dings. Ryan and Sharpay pull out their phones)

Ahhhhh, the dreaded cell phone symphony returns to our crucible of learning! Sharpay and Ryan Evans, your phones please, and I will see you in detention.

(Ms. Darbus lifts a bucket and waits for Ryan and Sharpay to drop their phones in, and notices that Gabriella is looking at her phone)

We have zero tolerance for cell phones in class, so we will get to know each other in detention. Welcome to East High, Ms. Montez.

(Ms. Darbus walks up to Troy)

Bolton. I see your phone is involved, so we will see you in detention as well.

CHAD

(stuttering)
Th-that's not even a possibility, Mrs. Your Honor. See, cause we have basketball practice and Troy--

MS. DARBUS

Ah, that'll be fifteen minutes for you too, Mr. Danforth. Count 'em!

TAYLOR

That could be tough for Chad cause he can't count that high

MS. DARBUS
Taylor McKessie! Fifteen minutes. Shall the carnage continue? The holidays are over people. Way over…

Now, any more comments? Questions? Okay, class dismissed.

(Students shuffle out of the classroom. Gabriella is the last to leave. Troy waits with nonchalance waiting for Gabriella to step out, and rushes up to her when she does. She brightens up when she sees him.)

TROY
(loud whispering)
Hey!

GABRIELLA
I don't --

TROY
-- believe it

GABRIELLA
Me --

TROY
-- either.. But how --

GABRIELLA
Well, my mom's company transferred her here to Albuquerque. I can't believe you live here, too. I looked for you at the lodge on New Year's Day, but --

TROY
We had to leave first thing.

GABRIELLA
(puzzled, and matching Troy's whisper)
Why are you whispering?

TROY
(in a normal voice)
What? Oh, well… my friends know about the snowboarding. I haven't quite told them about the… *(back to a whisper)* ...singing thing.

(Zeke walks up to quickly greet Troy and walks away to his next class)

GABRIELLA
(after Zeke gets out of earshot, sarcastically)
Too much for them to handle?

TROY
It was cool. But my friends… that's not what I do. That was like a… a different person.

(awkward silence)
So, anyway… welcome to East High! You've met Ms. Darbus so I bet you just can't wait to sign up for the show.

(Troy gestures to a sign-up sheet. Sharpay looms over it. Sharpay notices Troy talking to another girl and listens discreetly)

GABRIELLA

I won't be signing up for anything here for a while. I just want to get to know the school. But if you signed up, I'd consider coming to the show.

TROY

Yeah yeah, that's completely impossible.

SHARPAY

(interjecting)
What's impossible Troy? I wouldn't think "impossible" is even in your vocabulary.

(looks up and down Gabriella, then back to Troy)
So nice of you to show our new classmate around.

(to Gabriella)
Oh, were you going to sign up too? My brother and I star in all of the school's productions, and we really welcome newcomers. There's a lot of supporting roles in the show. I'm sure we can find something for you.

GABRIELLA

No, no. I was just looking over the bulletin board. Lots going on at this school.

(analyzes the sign-up sheet that Sharpay is guarding)
Wow… Nice penmanship.

(Gabriella walks away, leaving Troy alone with Sharpay. Troy realizes the situation and starts to slowly shuffle away from Sharpay but she rushes up to him to strike conversation.)

SHARPAY

So Troy, I missed you during vacation. What'd you do?

TROY

Oh you know, played basketball… snowboarding… more basketball.

SHARPAY

(bubbly)
So, when's the big game?

TROY

In two weeks.

SHARPAY

You are *so* dedicated… Just like me. I hope you come watch me in the musical. Promise?

(Troy awkwardly nods and walks away)

Toodles!

(Sharpay waits for Troy to leave and glares in the direction that Gabriella went, and walks to her next class)

[East High gymnasium]

(Troy sighs next to Chad, who is stretching. The jocks are to the side, stretching as a group)

TROY
Hey, you know that school musical thing? Pretty cool that Darbus is giving extra credit just for auditioning

CHAD
(surprised)
Do you think LeBron James or Shaquille O'Neal ever auditioned for their school musicals?

TROY
Maybe, but, you know… like the extra credit is good… for… college.

CHAD
Look, the music in those shows isn't hip-hop, or rock… or anything essential to culture. It's like… show music. It's all costumes and makeup. It's frightening.

TROY
(deflated)
Yeah, I know. Thought it'd be a good laugh. Sharpay's pretty cute too.

CHAD
So is a mountain lion. But you don't pet it.

(Chad walks away to join the rest of the jocks warming up. Troy sighs again.)

TROY
Okay Wildcats! Pair up! Let's go!

TROY
COACH SAID TO FAKE RIGHT
AND BREAK LEFT
WATCH OUT FOR THE PICK
AND KEEP AN EYE ON DEFENSE

GOTTA RUN THE GIVE AND GO
TAKE THE BALL TO THE HOLE
AND DON'T BE AFRAID TO SHOOT THE OUTSIDE J
UH, JUST KEEP YOUR HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
UH, JUST KEEP YOUR HEAD IN THE GAME

TROY
AND DON'T BE AFRAID TO SHOOT THE OUTSIDE J

JOCKS
UH, JUST KEEP YOUR HEAD IN THE GAME

TROY
YOU GOTTA GET'CHA, GET'CHA HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
WE GOTTA GET OUR, GET OUR, GET OUR, GET OUR HEAD IN THE GAME

TROY
COME ON, GET'CHA, GET'CHA HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
WE GOTTA GET OUR, GET OUR, GET OUR, GET OUR HEAD IN THE GAME

TROY, JOCKS
YOU GOTTA GET'CHA (GET OUR), GET'CHA (GET OUR) HEAD IN THE GAME

WOOOOOOOO

TROY
LET'S MAKE SURE THAT WE GET THE REBOUND
'CAUSE WHEN WE GET IT, THEN THE CROWD WILL GO WILD
A SECOND CHANCE, GOTTA GRAB IT AND GO
MAYBE THIS TIME WE'LL HIT THE RIGHT NOTES

(The jocks look at Troy confusedly)

TROY
WAIT A MINUTE – NOT THE TIME OR PLACE
WAIT A MINUTE – GET MY HEAD IN THE GAME
WAIT A MINUTE – GET MY HEAD IN THE GAME
WAIT A MINUTE, WAIT A MINUTE
GOTTA GET MY, GET MY HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
YOU GOTTA GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA HEAD IN THE GAME

TROY
I GOTTA GET MY, GET MY HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
YOU GOTTA GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA HEAD IN THE GAME

TROY
COME ON, GET MY, GET MY HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
YOU GOTTA GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA HEAD IN THE GAME

TROY, JOCKS
I GOTTA GET MY (GET'CHA), GET MY (GET'CHA) HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
YOU GOTTA GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA HEAD IN THE GAME

(Jocks drop out for Troy inner monologue)

TROY
WHY AM I FEELING SO WRONG?
MY HEAD'S IN THE GAME
BUT MY HEART'S IN THE SONG
SHE MAKES THIS FEEL SO RIGHT
Should I go for it? Better shake this. Yikes.

(Jocks return)

TROY
I GOTTA GET MY, GET MY HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
YOU GOTTA GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA HEAD IN THE GAME

TROY
COME ON, GET MY, GET MY HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
YOU GOTTA GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA HEAD IN THE GAME

TROY, JOCKS
I GOTTA GET MY (GET'CHA), GET MY (GET'CHA) HEAD IN THE GAME

JOCKS
YOU GOTTA GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA, GET'CHA HEAD IN THE GAME
WOOOOOOOOOOOO

(Troy stays behind, while Chad leads the rest of the jocks out of the gym with a chant.)

CHAD
What team?

JOCKS
Wildcats!

CHAD
What team?

JOCKS
Wildcats!

CHAD
Wildcats!

JOCKS
Keep your head in the game! WOO!

(Troy sighs and walks in the direction the jocks went)

[Chemistry Lab]

(Gabriella sits next to Taylor, both working on the equation that Ms. Tenney has on the board. Sharpay sneaks up behind Gabriella)

SHARPAY
So, it seems you knew Troy Bolton?

GABRIELLA
(trying to focus on schoolwork)
Not really. He was just showing me around

SHARPAY
Troy doesn't usually interact with new students.

GABRIELLA
Why not?

(Gabriella looks back and forth between her notes and the board because her answer looks different from what Ms. Tenney has)

SHARPAY
It's pretty much basketball 24/7 with him.

GABRIELLA
(not paying attention to Sharpay)
It should be 16 over pi.

MS. TENNEY
Yes, Gabriella?

GABRIELLA
Shouldn't the second equation read 16 over pi?

(Taylor is shocked and looks over her own notes and over at Gabriella's)

MS. TENNEY
16 over pi? That's quite impossible… *(looks at it more closely)* I stand corrected. Oh, and welcome aboard.

[School hallway]

(Troy walks up to the sign-up sheet, scans it over, nods and walks away. Ryan watches from the wings. Sharpay walks by and Ryan gets her attention, hurriedly)

RYAN
Troy Bolton was looking at *our* audition list.

SHARPAY
Again? You know, he was hanging around with that new girl and they were both looking at the list. There's something freaky about her. Did you Google her like I asked?

RYAN
(showing a news article to Sharpay while reading the title aloud)
"Whiz Kid Leads School to Scholastic Championship". An Einstenette. So why do you think she's interested in our musical?

SHARPAY
I'm not sure that she is. And we needn't concern ourselves with amateurs. But… there is no harm in making certain that Gabriella is welcomed to school activities that are appropriate for her. After all, she loves pie. Make sure there's a copy of this in Taylor's locker.

[Theater Room for detention]

(Ms. Darbus is aggravated and overseeing all of the students to spur them to work harder on the sets and costumes for the school musical)

(Taylor briskly walks up to Gabriella, beaming. Sharpay and Ryan are eavesdropping nearby)

TAYLOR
The answer is yes!

GABRIELLA
Huh?

TAYLOR
(waving the printed out article at Gabriella)
Our Science Decathlon team has our first regional competition next week, and there is certainly a spot for you.

GABRIELLA
(stunned)
Where did those come from?

TAYLOR
Didn't you put them in my locker?

GABRIELLA
Of course not.

(Sharpay and Ryan share a mischievous glance)

TAYLOR
Oh. Well, we'd love to have you on our team. We meet almost every day after school. Please?

GABRIELLA
I need to catch up on the curriculum here, before I think about joining any clubs.

SHARPAY
Well, what a perfect way to get caught up… meeting with the smartest kids in the school. What a generous offer, Taylor!

MS. DARBUS
So many new faces in detention today. I hope you don't make a habit of it, but the drama club can always use an extra hand. And while we are working, let us probe the mounting evils of cell phones. Perhaps the most heinous example of cell phone abuse is ringing in the theater. The theater is a temple of art. A precious cornucopia of creative energy--

(Coach Bolton rushes in, angrily)

COACH BOLTON
Where's my team, Darbus? And what the heck are those two doing in a tree? *(points at Chad and Troy, who are working on a stage set)*

MS. DARBUS
Crime and punishment, Bolton. Besides, proximity to the arts is cleansing for the soul.

COACH BOLTON
Can we have a talk, please? And you two *(points at Chad and Troy again)*, into the gym, now.

(Troy and Chad scurry off. Ms. Darbus sighs and waves at the rest of the students to dismiss them from detention. Coach Bolton waits for the students to leave before continuing)

If they have to paint sets for detention, they can do it tonight, not during my practice. Darbus, we are days away from the biggest game of the year.

MS. DARBUS
And we, Bolton, are in the midst of auditions for our winter musical. This school is about more than young men in baggy shorts flinging balls for touchdowns.

COACH BOLTON
Baskets. They shoot baskets. The West High Knights have knocked us out of the playoffs for three years straight.

MS. DARBUS
Yes, and despite your consistent track record of defeat, the school board still sees fit to allocate ten times the amount of money for school athletics as it does for the arts programs.

COACH BOLTON
Win, lose, it doesn't matter. I'm trying to teach these kids about having a goal, about teamwork, something they can use as adults.

MS. DARBUS
(seeing some possible common ground)
Which is precisely what I am trying to instill in them.

COACH BOLTON
(not understanding)
How, by making them scream at the top of their lungs?

(Ms. Darbus and Coach Bolton huff at each other, and walk their separate ways)

[Outside the school]

(Gabriella is walking with Taylor as Taylor attempts to convince her to join the decathlon team again)

TAYLOR
We've never made it past the first round of the scholastic decathlon. You could be our answered prayer.

GABRIELLA
I'm going to focus on my studies this semester, and help my mom get the new house organized. Maybe next year.

TAYLOR
But--

GABRIELLA
What do you know about Troy Bolton?

TAYLOR
Troy? Hmm. I wouldn't consider myself an expert on that subspecies, as in…

(in a valley girl accent)
Ohmigod, isn't Troy Bolton just the hottie super bomb?

GABRIELLA
(chuckling)
I guess I don't speak cheerleader.

TAYLOR
Which is why we exist in an alternate universe to Troy the Basketball Boy.

GABRIELLA
Have you tried to get to know him?

TAYLOR
He has his clique. I have mine. Watch how it works in the cafeteria when you have lunch with us. Unless you'd rather sit with the cheerleaders.

[Bolton Residence, basketball court]

(Coach Bolton and Troy are playing pickup)

COACH BOLTON
I still don't understand this whole detention thing.

TROY
It was my fault. Sorry dad.

COACH BOLTON
You know, Darbus will take any opportunity to bust my chops. That includes yours, too.

TROY
Hey dad? You ever think about trying something new, but were afraid of what your friends might think?

COACH BOLTON
You mean like going left? Yours is fine.

TROY
Well, no. What if you want to try something really new, and it's a total disaster and all of your friends laugh at you.

COACH BOLTON
Well then maybe they're not really your friends. That was my whole point about teamwork. You guys gotta look out for each other, and you're the leader. There's gonna be college scouts at the game this week, Troy. Do you know how much a scholarship is worth these days?

TROY
A lot.

COACH BOLTON
Right, so focus, Troy. Come on.

[Theater Room]

(Troy sneaks in to the back of the room to observe the auditions that are ongoing for the school musical. Kelsi is providing musical accompaniment, while Sharpay and Ryan wince behind Ms Darbus at the auditions)

SUSAN

IT'S HARD TO BELIEVE
THAT I COULDN'T SEE
YOU WERE ALWAYS THERE BESIDE ME

MS. DARBUS

That's lovely, Susan. Such emotion, such… uhm… well that concludes our auditions for supporting cast. And for the lead roles, we only have one couple signed up – Sharpay and Ryan – I think it would be useful for you to give a sense of why we gather in this hallowed hall.

(Sharpay and Ryan step up to audition)

KELSI

Uhm… what key?

RYAN

Oh, we had our rehearsal pianist do an arrangement.

(Sharpay and Ryan take center stage for their audition, turn to the side and do raspberries to warm up. Ms. Darbus watches with glee, Kelsi looks mortified)

RYAN

IT'S HARD TO BELIEVE
THAT I COULDN'T SEE

SHARPAY, RYAN

YOU WERE ALWAYS THERE BESIDE ME
THOUGHT I WAS ALONE
WITH NO ONE TO HOLD
BUT YOU WERE ALWAYS RIGHT BESIDE ME

SHARPAY

THIS FEELING'S LIKE NO OTHER

SHARPAY, RYAN

I WANT YOU TO KNOW

I'VE NEVER HAD SOMEONE
THAT KNOWS ME LIKE YOU DO
THE WAY YOU DO
I'VE NEVER HAD SOMEONE
AS GOOD FOR ME AS YOU
NO ONE LIKE YOU
SO LONELY BEFORE
I FINALLY FOUND
WHAT I'VE BEEN LOOKING FOR

SHARPAY

SO GOOD TO BE SEEN
SO GOOD TO BE HEARD

SHARPAY, RYAN
DON'T HAVE TO SAY A WORD

RYAN
FOR SO LONG I WAS LOST
SO GOOD TO BE FOUND

SHARPAY, RYAN
I'M LOVING HAVING YOU AROUND

RYAN
THIS FEELING'S LIKE NO OTHER
I WANT YOU TO KNOW

SHARPAY, RYAN
I'VE NEVER HAD SOMEONE
THAT KNOWS ME LIKE YOU DO
THE WAY YOU DO
I'VE NEVER HAD SOMEONE
AS GOOD FOR ME AS YOU
NO ONE LIKE YOU

SO LONELY BEFORE
I FINALLY FOUND
WHAT I'VE BEEN LOOKING FOR
DOO DOO DOO, DOOT DOO DOO DOO DOOT DOO
A WHOA OH OH OHHHH
DOO DOO DOO, DOOT DOO DOO DOO DOOT DOO
A WHOA OH OH OHHHH

(Sharpay and Ryan pose to end the song)

SHARPAY
(whispering)
I told you not to do the jazz squares

RYAN
Everyone likes a good jazz square

(Sharpay glares at Kelsi until she starts applauding)

MS. DARBUS
Well, my dears, it seems we are out of time. Any last minute sign-ups for Juliet? Romeo?

(Ms. Darbus looks around, Troy ducks to make sure he's not spotted)

Well, then I suppose we're done for the day. Remember, callbacks will be held next week.

(The students, except for Kelsi, Sharpay, Ryan, and Troy – who is still hiding, shuffle out of the auditorium. Ryan goads other students as they all leave)

RYAN
Don't be discouraged! The drama club doesn't just need performers… it needs fans, too! Buy tickets!

(Ryan waits by the exit for Sharpay)

KELSI

(walking up to Sharpay)
Actually, if you do the part with that particular song, I imagined it much slower--

SHARPAY

-- *IF* we do the part? Kelsi… Kelsi darling, I've been in seventeen school productions. And how many times have your compositions been selected?

KELSI

This would be the first.

SHARPAY

(leading)
Which tells us what?

KELSI

That… I need to write you more solos--

SHARPAY

It tells us that you do not offer direction, suggestion, or commentary. And you should be thankful that Ryan and I are here to lift your music out of its current obscurity. Are we clear?

KELSI

Yes ma'am – I mean, Sharpay.

SHARPAY

Nice talking to you.

(Sharpay joins Ryan and exits the auditorium. Gabriella sees Troy hiding behind the stage and promptly walks up to Ms. Darbus)

GABRIELLA

I'd like to audition, Ms. Darbus.

MS. DARBUS

Oh, I'm sorry but timing means everything in the world of theatre.

GABRIELLA

But I --

MS. DARBUS

I'm afraid the individual auditions are long over, Ms. Montez. And well, there is no one to sing with you for the lead parts.

(Troy musters up the courage to step out)

TROY

(meekly)
I'll sing with her.

MS. DARBUS

Troy Bolton? And where is your sports posse, or whatever it's called?

TROY

Team. But I'm here alone. Actually… I'm here to sing with her.

MS. DARBUS
Yes, well, I treat these shows just as seriously as your father treats his basketball practices. I called for the pairs auditions, and you didn't respond. I am very sorry, but we've simply run out of time.

TROY
But she has an amazing voice--

MS. DARBUS
Perhaps the next musical.

(Ms. Darbus exits the auditorium. Kelsi looks over her music and notes dejectedly, and trips. Troy and Gabriella rush over to help her up)

TROY
So you're a composer. You wrote that song that Ryan and Sharpay just sang?

(Kelsi nods)

And the entire show?

(Kelsi nods again)

Well, that's really cool. I uh, can't wait to hear the rest of the show. So… why are you so afraid of Ryan and Sharpay. Isn't it your show?

KELSI
It is?

TROY
Isn't the composer of a show like the playmaker in basketball?

KELSI
Playmaker?

TROY
You know, the one that makes everyone else look good. Without you, there is no show. You're the playmaker here, Kelsi.

KELSI
I am? … You wanna hear the way that song is supposed to sound?

(Kelsi beckons Troy and Gabriella over to the piano and shows them the music)

TROY
IT'S HARD TO BELIEVE THAT I COULDN'T SEE
YOU WERE ALWAYS THERE BESIDE ME

GABRIELLA
THOUGHT I WAS ALONE WITH NO ONE TO HOLD

TROY, GABRIELLA
BUT YOU WERE ALWAYS RIGHT BESIDE ME
THIS FEELING'S LIKE NO OTHER
I WANT YOU TO KNOW

(Kelsi nods enthusiastically at their performance)

I'VE NEVER HAD SOMEONE
WHO KNOWS ME LIKE YOU DO
THE WAY YOU DO

(Ms. Darbus peeks back in and listens)

AND I'VE NEVER HAD SOMEONE
AS GOOD FOR ME AS YOU
NO ONE LIKE YOU

SO LONELY BEFORE I FINALLY FOUND
WHAT I'VE BEEN LOOKING FOR

(They all look at each other smiling, content with the performance)

MS. DARBUS
Bolton! Montez! You have a callback. Kelsi, give them the duet in the second act. Work on it with them.

KELSI
(excitedly)
If you want to rehearse, I'm usually in the music room during free period, and after school… and sometimes during biology class. You can come and rehearse with me anytime. Or you can come to my house for breakfast – I have a piano, we can rehearse there. After school, before school, whatever works. After basketball practice!

(Kelsi leads Troy and Gabriella out of the auditorium)

[East High cafeteria]

(Ryan and Sharpay are distressed. The jocks are lounging nearby)

SHARPAY
CALLBACKS??!!! AAHHHHHHHHHHHHHH!

(Sharpay starts hyperventilating)

RYAN
(reading the bulletin on his phone)
Callbacks for the roles of Romeo and Juliet… Ryan and Sharpay Evans… Gabriella Montez and Troy Bolton.

SHARPAY
Is this some kind of joke?! They didn't even audition.

RYAN
Maybe we're being punked. Maybe… we're being filmed right now. Maybe we'll get to meet Ashton--

SHARPAY
Oh shut up, Ryan!

(the jocks start laughing as they encircle Ryan and Sharpay)

CHAD

(sneering)
What's wrong?

(Chad examines the bulletin board and reads it aloud)
Gabriella Montez and… Troy? What?

(Chad leads the jocks away from Ryan and Sharpay to talk amongst themselves)

RYAN

They never even asked for our permission to join the dram club. I mean, come on!

SHARPAY

Someone's gotta tell that new girl the rules.

RYAN

Right… uhm, what are the rules again?

SHARPAY

Rule number one: Pick the right clique.
Two: Act like your clique.
Three: Dress like your clique.
Four: Know where your clique clicks.
And rule number five: *Stick to the status quo!*

(music starts when Zeke enters the cafeteria)

(Sharpay looks over at all of the students in their respective cliques from the balcony)

ZEKE

YOU CAN BET THERE'S NOTHING BUT NET
WHEN I AM IN THE ZONE AND ON A ROLL
BUT I'VE GOT A CONFESSION
MY OWN SECRET OBSESSION
AND IT'S MAKING ME LOSE CONTROL

ALL

EVERYBODY GATHER ROUND

ZEKE

Well, if Troy can tell his secret then I can tell mine. I bake. I love to bake. Scones, strudel, and even apple pandowdy.

ALL

NOT ANOTHER SOUND

ZEKE

Someday, I hope to make the perfect crème brulée.

ALL

NO NO NO NO! (NO NO NO)
STICK TO THE STUFF YOU KNOW
IF YOU WANNA BE COOL
FOLLOW ONE SIMPLE RULE
DON'T MESS WITH THE FLOW, NO, NO
STICK TO THE STATUS QUO

MARTHA
LOOK AT ME AND WHAT DO YOU SEE
INTELLIGENCE BEYOND COMPARE
BUT INSIDE I AM STIRRING
SOMETHING STRANGE IS OCCURRING
IT'S A SECRET I NEED TO SHARE

ALL
OPEN UP, DIG WAY DOWN DEEP

MARTHA
Hip-hop is my passion. I love to pop, lock, break and jam.

CHAD
Is that even legal?

ALL
NOT ANOTHER PEEP

MARTHA
It's just dancing. And the truth is, sometimes I think it's even cooler than homework.

ALL
NO, NO, NO NO! (NO, NO, NO)
STICK TO THE STUFF YOU KNOW
IT'S BETTER BY FAR
TO KEEP THE THINGS AS THEY ARE
DON'T MESS WITH THE FLOW, NO, NO
STICK TO THE STATUS QUO

(key change up a half step)

RIPPER
LISTEN WELL, I'M READY TO TELL
ABOUT A NEED THAT I CANNOT DENY
DUDE, THERE'S NO EXPLANATION
FOR THIS AWESOME SENSATION
BUT I'M READY TO LET IT FLY

ALL
SPEAK YOUR MIND AND YOU'LL BE HEARD

RIPPER
Alright, if Troy can be in a show, then I'm coming clean. I play the cello.

ALL
NOT ANOTHER WORD

RIPPER
I even have to wear a suit and tie.

ALL

NO, NO, NO, NO! (NO, NO, NO)
STICK TO THE STUFF YOU KNOW
IF YOU WANNA BE COOL
FOLLOW ONE SIMPLE RULE
STICK TO THE STATUS QUO

NO, NO. NO, NO! (NO, NO, NO)
STICK TO THE STUFF YOU KNOW
IT'S BETTER BY FAR
TO KEEP THE THINGS AS THEY ARE
DON'T MESS WITH THE FLOW, NO, NO
STICK TO THE STATUS QUO

SHARPAY

THIS IS NOT WHAT I WANT
THIS IS NOT WHAT I PLANNED
AND I JUST GOTTA SAY
I DO NOT UNDERSTAND
SOMETHING IS REALLY…

RYAN

SOMETHING'S NOT RIGHT

SHARPAY

… REALLY WRONG

SHARPAY, RYAN

AND WE GOTTA GET THINGS
BACK WHERE THEY BELONG

WE CAN DO IT

RIPPER

Gotta play!

ALL

STICK WITH WHAT YOU KNOW

SHARPAY

WE CAN DO IT

MARTHA

Hip-hop hurray!

ALL

THEY HAVE TO GO

SHARPAY

WE CAN DO IT

ZEKE

Crème brulée!

ALL

(gradually getting louder)
KEEP YOUR VOICE DOWN LOW
NOT ANOTHER PEEP (NO)
NOT ANOTHER WORD (NO)
NOT ANOTHER SOUND (NO)

SHARPAY

Everybody quiet!

(Gabriella walks in and looks confused as to why everyone is staring at her. Sharpay glares directly at her)

GABRIELLA

(to Taylor)
Why is everybody staring at you?

TAYLOR

Not me. You.

GABRIELLA

Because of the callbacks? I can't have everybody staring at me. I really can't--

ALL

NOOOOOO (NO, NO, NO)
STICK TO THE STUFF YOU KNOW
IF YOU WANNA BE COOL
FOLLOW ONE SIMPLE RULE
STICK TO THE STATUS QUO

NO, NO. NO, NO! (NO, NO, NO)
STICK TO THE STUFF YOU KNOW
IT'S BETTER BY FAR
TO KEEP THE THINGS AS THEY ARE
DON'T MESS WITH THE FLOW, NO, NO
STICK TO THE STATUS --
STICK TO THE STATUS --
STICK TO THE STATUS QUO

(Gabriella spills her lunch on Sharpay, who promptly screams)

[END OF ACT ONE]

[Coach Bolton's office]

(Coach Bolton is lounging. Ms. Darbus storms in)

MS. DARBUS

How dare you?!

COACH BOLTON

What?

MS. DARBUS
In all my years in the theatre, never have I encountered such childish, small-minded subterfuge. Your pathetic male ego is all bent out of shape because I put your stars in detention, so now you're getting even?

COACH BOLTON
What are you talking about, Darbus?

MS. DARBUS
Some very reliable sources told me all about your little plot to humiliate me and the Drama Club, and I am telling you it ain't gonna fly!

COACH BOLTON
Save the speeches for the stage.

MS. DARBUS
Your all-star son turned up at my audition. Now, I give every student an even chance, which is a long and honorable tradition in the theatre – something that you wouldn't understand… But, if he is planning some kind of practical joke in my chapel of the arts--

COACH BOLTON
Troy doesn't even sing.

MS. DARBUS
Well, you're wrong about that. But I will not allow my neo-feminist Romeo and Juliet to be made into a farce--

(Coach Bolton tries to control his laughter)

See! I knew it! Good day.

(Ms. Darbus briskly walks out of his office)

[East High hallway, Sharpay's locker]

(Sharpay is angrily examining herself in the mirror installed in her locker, trying to wipe away the food that Gabriella had spilled on her during lunch. Zeke slides in next to her to strike up a conversation.)

ZEKE
Hey Sharpay, I just thought that since Troy Bolton is gonna be in your show--

SHARPAY
Troy Bolton is *not* in my show.

ZEKE
Okay, uhm well I just thought maybe you could watch me play ball or something

SHARPAY
I'd rather stick pins in my eyes.

ZEKE
Wouldn't that be awfully uncomfortable?

SHARPAY

Evaporate, tall person!

(Sharpay slams her locker closed and storms off)

ZEKE

… I bake! … if that helps

[Rooftop Garden]
(Troy nervously paces until Gabriella walks up)

GABRIELLA

Wow, It's like a jungle up here.

TROY

Yeah, just like that cafeteria.

GABRIELLA

Well, I just humiliated myself into the next century.

TROY

Noooooo.

GABRIELLA

So this is your private hideout?

TROY

Yeah, thanks to the Science Club, which means my buddies don't even know it exists.

GABRIELLA

Seems to me like everyone on campus wants to be your friend.

TROY

Unless we lose.

GABRIELLA

Must be tricky being the coach's son.

TROY

Makes me practice a little harder, I guess… I don't know what he's gonna say when he finds out about the singing.

GABRIELLA

You're worried?

TROY

My parents' friends are always saying, "Your son is the basketball guy. You must be so proud." Sometimes I don't want to be "the basketball guy." I just want to be a guy, you know.

GABRIELLA

I saw how you treated Kelsi at the audition yesterday. Do your friends know that guy?

TROY

To them, I'm "the playmaker dude."

GABRIELLA
Then they don't know enough about you, Troy. At my other schools, I was "the freaky math girl." It's cool coming here and being anyone I wanna be. When I was singing with you I just felt like a girl.

TROY
You even look like one, too.

GABRIELLA
You remember in kindergarten, you'd meet a kid, know nothing about them, then ten seconds later you were playing like you were best friends, because you didn't have to be anything but yourself?

TROY
Yeah.

GABRIELLA
Singing with you felt like that. Like, safe, you know?

TROY
I never thought about singing, that's for sure… till you.

GABRIELLA
So you really want to do the callbacks?

TROY
Hey, just call me "the freaky callback guy."

GABRIELLA
You're a cool guy, Troy. But not for the reason your friends think. And thanks for showing me your top secret hiding place – like kindergarten.

[East High gymnasium]
(Coach Bolton and the jocks are practicing drills. Troy is not present)

COACH BOLTON
Come on guys! Hustle! Get your head in the game!

(to Chad)
Have you seen Troy?

CHAD
No, sir…

COACH BOLTON
(with a heavy sigh)
Alright good job guys. Hit the showers.

(the jocks jog off towards the locker room. Troy hurriedly rushes into the gym from that direction past the jocks, and awkwardly stands next to his dad)

TROY
(not making eye contact)
… I uh … came here to stay a while. Work on my free throws.

COACH BOLTON
Well since you missed practice again, I think your team deserves a little effort from you today.

(Coach Bolton walks off in the direction of the locker room. Troy starts working on his jump shot, Gabriella walks in)

GABRIELLA
Wow, so this is your real stage.

TROY
I guess you could call it that. Or just a smelly gym.

(Troy passes the ball to Gabriella, who shoots and makes a basket.)

Whoa, don't tell me you're good at hoops, too?

GABRIELLA
I once scored forty-one points in a league championship game.

TROY
No way.

GABRIELLA
Mhm. The same day, I invented the space shuttle and microwave popcorn… I've been rehearsing with Kelsi.

TROY
Me too.

(in a serious tone)
And, by the way, I missed practice so if I get kicked off the team, it should be on your conscience.

GABRIELLA
(flustered)
I wasn't the one who told you to--

TROY
(jokingly)
Gabriella. Chill.

(The two play fight and don't notice Coach Bolton walk back into the gym)

COACH BOLTON
Miss, I'm sorry, this is a closed practice.

TROY
Dad, come on, practice is over.

COACH BOLTON
Not until the last player leaves the gym. Team rule.

GABRIELLA
Oh, I'm sorry, sir.

TROY

Dad, this is Gabriella Montez.

COACH BOLTON

(coldly)
Ah, your detention buddy.

GABRIELLA

(sensing the animosity)
I'll see you later, Troy. Uh, nice meeting you, Coach Bolton.

(Gabriella hurries out of the gym)

COACH BOLTON

(not making eye contact)
You as well, Miss Montez.

TROY

Dad, detention was my fault. Not hers.

COACH BOLTON

You haven't missed practice in three years. *That girl* shows up and--

TROY

That girl is named Gabriella. She's very nice.

(the jocks eavesdrop from a distance)

COACH BOLTON

Well, helping you miss practice doesn't make her "very nice." Not in my book. Or your team's.

TROY

She's not a problem. She's just a girl.

COACH BOLTON

(angrily)
But you're not "just a guy," Troy. You're the team leader, what you do affects not only this team, but the entire school. Without you completely focused, we won't win the game next week. And championship games don't come along every day… they're something special.

TROY

Yeah, well a lot of things are special, Dad.

COACH BOLTON

But you're a playmaker… not a singer, right?

TROY

Did you ever think maybe I could be both?

(Troy walks in the direction of the locker room and the jocks scatter)

[East High library]
(Chad is frustratedly trying to convince Troy to focus on the game)

CHAD
What spell has this elevated-IQ temptress girl cast that suddenly makes *you* want to be in a musical?

TROY
Look, I just did it. Who cares?

CHAD
Who cares?! How about your most loyal best friend? Look, you're a hoops dude, not a musical singer person.

(Troy tries to walk away, but Chad persistently follows)

Have you ever seen Michael Crawford on a cereal box?

TROY
Who's Michael Crawford?

CHAD
Exactly my point! He was the Phantom of the Opera on Broadway. Now my mom, she's seen that musical 27 times, and she put Michael Crawford's picture in our refrigerator. Yeah, not *on* it. *In* it. So, my point is if you play basketball, you're gonna end up on a cereal box… but if you sing in musicals, you're gonna end up in my mom's fridge.

TROY
(worried)
Why would she put a picture of him in your refrigerator?

CHAD
One of her crazy diet ideas-- Look, I don't attempt to understand the female mind, Troy. How can you expect us to be focused on a game while you're off somewhere in leotards singing Twinkle Town?

TROY
No one said anything about leotards.

CHAD
Not yet, my friend, but just you wait. Look, we need you, Captain. Big time.

(Chad waits for Troy to respond, but walks away frustratedly when Troy refuses to make eye contact with him)

[East High, science club]

(Sharpay and Ryan are talking amongst themselves outside. Chad walks into the classroom to talk to Taylor. Sharpay and Ryan eavesdrop)

CHAD
We need to talk.

(Chad and Taylor converse inaudibly)

SHARPAY
Something isn't right.

RYAN
They must be trying to figure out a way for Troy and Gabriella to actually beat us out. Now, the jocks don't rule the school, but if they get Troy into the school musical, they'll conquer the entire student body.

SHARPAY
And if those science girls get Gabriella hooked up with Troy Bolton, the scholastic club goes from drool to cool. Ryan, we need to save our show from people who don't know the difference between a Tony award and Tony Hawk.

(Sharpay and Ryan walk away)

TAYLOR
(to Chad)
Do you really think that's going to work?

CHAD
It's the only way to save Troy and Gabriella from themselves. So, we on?

TAYLOR
Yeah.

CHAD
Good, so uh, we start tomorrow then.

[East High, locker room on one side, science classroom on the other]

(On one half of the stage, Taylor is waiting patiently with the Brainiacs. On the other, Chad and the jocks are waiting patiently. Troy wanders in and is surprised that they're all waiting for him.)

CHAD
"Spider" Bill Natrine. Class of '72. He was the MVP in the league championship game.

ZEKE
Sam Netletter. Class of '02. Also known as "Sammie Slamma-Jamma." Captain, MVP of the championship game.

CHAD
"The Thunderclap" Hap Haddon.

(The jocks clap in unison)

Class of '95. Led the Wildcats to back-to-back state championships. A legend. Yes, legends, one and all. Do you think any of these Wildcat legends became legends by getting involved in musical auditions just days before the league championships?

JOCKS
Get'cha head in the game!

CHAD
These legends became legends because they never took their eyes off the prize.

JOCKS
Get'cha head in the game!

CHAD
Now, who was the first sophomore *ever* to make starting varsity?

JOCKS
Troy!

CHAD
Who voted him as our team captain this year?

JOCKS
Us!

CHAD
And who is going to get their sorry butts kicked in Friday's championship game if Troy's worried about an audition?

ZEKE
We are…

TROY
Guys, come on. You know, there's twelve people on this team, not just me.

CHAD
Twelve? Oh, no. I think you're forgetting one very important thirteenth member of our squad. Wildcat basketball champion of 1981. Champion, father, and now coach. It's a winning tradition like no other.

(Jocks freeze out of focus for the scene. Taylor beckons Gabriella to come join the Brainiacs in the classroom and begins to monologue)

TAYLOR
From lowly Neanderthal and Cro-Magnon, to early warriors and medieval knights, all leading up to lunkhead basketball man.

(Gabriella rolls her eyes, as Taylor continues)

Yes, our culture worshipped the aggressor throughout the ages, and we end up with spoiled, overpaid, bonehead athletes who contribute to little to society outside of slam dunks and touchdowns. That is the inevitable world of Troy Bolton. But the path of the mind, the path we're on… ours is the path that brought us these people: Eleanor Roosevelt, Frida Kahlo, Sandra Day O'Connor, Madame Curie, Jane Goodall… Oprah Winfrey, and so many others who the world reveres.

GABRIELLA
What is… I've got Kelsi waiting for me to rehearse--

TAYLOR
Gabriella! Troy Bolton represents one side of evolution, and our side, the side of education and accomplishment is the future of civilization. This is the side where you belong.

TROY
Guys, if you don't know that I'll put one hundred and ten percent of my guts into the game, then you don't know me at all.

CHAD

We just thought--

TROY

I'll tell you what I thought. I thought you were my friends. Win together, lose together, teammates.

CHAD

But suddenly the girl… and the singing…

(Zeke sneakily starts recording Troy's reaction. Taylor shows the livestream to Gabriella in the classroom while Troy and Chad argue)

TROY

Man, I'm for the team! I've always been for the team. She's just someone I met. Alright, the singing thing is nothing. Probably something to keep my nerves down. The singing means nothing to me. You're my guys and you're my team. Gabriella means nothing to me. I'll forget about her. I'll forget about the audition, and we'll go out there and win that championship. Happy now?

TAYLOR

Behold… lunkhead basketball man. So, Gabriella, we'd love to have you for the scholastic decathlon. So… did you want to grab some lunch?

(visibly upset and holding back tears, Gabriella shakes her head no)

Well, we'll be there, if you wanna come.

(Taylor and the Brainiacs leave Gabriella alone in the classroom while the jocks start cheering in the locker room)

CHAD

Wildcats!

JOCKS

Get'cha head in the game!

CHAD

Wildcats!

JOCKS

Get'cha head in the game! Wooooo!

(A pep rally forms around the jocks. Gabriella looks onward from upstairs, mournfully)

PEP RALLY

WILDCATS, SING ALONG
YEAH, YOU REALLY GOT IT GOIN' ON
WILDCATS IN THE HOUSE
EVERYBODY SAY IT NOW
WILDCATS EVERYWHERE
WAVE YOUR HANDS UP IN THE AIR
THAT'S THE WAY WE DO IT
LET'S GET TO IT
TIME TO SHOW THE WORLD

(the crowd starts chanting "Troy" and all walk off-stage, leaving Gabriella alone at the balcony)

GABRIELLA

IT'S FUNNY WHEN YOU FIND YOURSELF
LOOKING FROM THE OUTSIDE
I'M STANDING HERE BUT ALL I WANT
IS TO BE OVER THERE
WHY DID I LET MYSELF BELIEVE
MIRACLES COULD HAPPEN
CAUSE NOW I HAVE TO PRETEND
THAT I DON'T REALLY CARE

I THOUGHT YOU WERE MY FAIRY TALE
MY DREAM WHEN IM NOT SLEEPING
A WISH UPON A STAR THAT'S COMING TRUE

BUT EVERYBODY ELSE COULD TELL
THAT I CONFUSED MY FEELINGS WITH THE TRUTH
WHEN THERE WAS ME AND YOU

I SWORE I KNEW THE MELODY
THAT I HEARD YOU SINGING
AND WHEN WE SMILED YOU MADE ME FEEL
LIKE I COULD SING ALONG
BUT THEN YOU WENT
AND CHANGED THE WORDS
NOW MY HEART IS EMPTY
I'M ONLY LEFT WITH "USED TO BE'S"
AND "ONCE UPON A SONG"

NOW I KNOW YOU'RE NOT A FAIRY TALE
AND DREAMS ARE MEANT FOR SLEEPING
AND WISHES ON A STAR JUST DON'T COME TRUE
CAUSE NOW EVEN I CAN TELL
THAT I CONFUSED MY FEELINGS WITH THE TRUTH
BECAUSE I LIKED THE VIEW
WHEN THERE WAS ME AND YOU

I CAN'T BELIEVE THAT I COULD BE SO BLIND
IT'S LIKE YOU WERE FLOATING WHILE I WAS FALLING
AND I DIDN'T MIND

BECAUSE I LIKED THE VIEW
I THOUGHT YOU FELT IT TOO
WHEN THERE WAS ME AND YOU

(Gabriella walks up to her locker and mopes. Troy struts up to talk to her)

TROY

Hey, how you doing?

(Gabriella doesn't respond or look at him)

Listen, there's something I want to talk to you about.

GABRIELLA
And here it is. I know what it's like to carry a load with your friends. I get it. You got your boys, Troy. It's okay. So we're good.

TROY
(slightly confused)
Good about what? I was gonna talk to you about the final callbacks.

GABRIELLA
I don't want to do the callbacks, either. Who are we trying to kid? You've got your team and I've got mine. I'll do the scholastic decathlon and you'll win the championships. It's where we belong. Go Wildcats…

TROY
But I--

GABRIELLA
Me neither.

(Gabriella brushes past him and walks directly past Taylor)

TAYLOR
Oh hey--

(Chad warmly greets Troy)
Hey, captain!

(Troy doesn't respond and walks away, Taylor and Chad look at each other confusedly, then walk their separate ways)

[East High, rooftop garden and science classroom]

(In the rooftop garden, Troy mopes around. Chad and Zeke slowly approach him. Gabriella sits alone in the science classroom)

CHAD
Hey, um, we just had another team meeting.

TROY
Oh. Wonderful.

CHAD
We had a team meeting about how we aren't acting like a team. I mean us, not you. Look, about the singing thing, we--

TROY
Look, dude, I don't even wanna talk about it.

CHAD
We just wanted you to know we're gonna be there, cheering for you.

TROY
Huh?

ZEKE
Yeah, if singing is what you wanna do, we should be boosting you up, not tearing you down.

CHAD
Yeah, win or lose, we're teammates. That's what we're about. Even if you turn out to be the worst singer in the world--

ZEKE
Which we don't know, because we haven't actually heard you sing.

TROY
And you're not gonna hear me sing, guys. Cause Gabriella won't even talk to me, and I don't know why.

CHAD
We do.

ZEKE
I baked these fresh today. You probably want to try one before we tell you the rest.

(Taylor walks up to Gabriella in the classroom)

TAYLOR
Gabriella, we were jerks. No, we were worse than jerks because we were mean jerks. We thought that Troy and the whole singing thing were killing our chances of having you on the scholastic decathlon team.

GABRIELLA
I heard what he had to say. I'm on your team now. Done.

TAYLOR
No, not done. We knew that Chad could get him to say things to make you want to forget the callbacks. We planned it, and we're embarrassed and sorry.

GABRIELLA
No one forced Troy to say anything. And you know what, it's okay. We should be preparing for the decathlon now, so it's time to move on.

TAYLOR
No, it's not okay. The decathlon is whatever, but how you feel about us – and even more, Troy – that's what really matters.

(Gabriella turns away and goes back to preparing for the decathlon.)

(Taylor sighs and walks away)
We tried.

[Montez residence]

(Gabriella is studying in her room. Troy sneaks in to the backyard, and calls her. She picks up reluctantly)

GABRIELLA
Hello?

TROY
What you heard the other day, none of that is true. I was sick of my friends riding me about singing with you so I said things I knew would shut them up. I didn't mean any of it.

GABRIELLA
You sounded pretty convincing to me.

TROY
Listen, the guy you met on vacation is way more me than the guy who said those stupid things.

GABRIELLA
Troy, the whole singing thing is making the school wack. I mean, you said so yourself, everyone's treating you differently because of it.

TROY
Maybe that's because I don't only want to be the basketball guy. They can't handle it. That's not my problem, it's theirs.

GABRIELLA
(Gabriella starts pacing around)
And your dad...

TROY
And it's not about my dad. This is about how I feel and I'm not letting the team down. They let me down. So, I'm going to sing. What about you?

GABRIELLA
(She stops and keeps her back to Troy. Troy slowly approaches until he is behind her)
I don't know, Troy.

TROY
Well you need to say yes, cause I've brought you something.

GABRIELLA
What do you mean?

TROY
Turn around.

(Gabriella turns around, they make eye contact and she is stunned. Troy starts singing their karaoke song a capella)

THIS COULD BE THE START OF SOMETHING NEW
IT FEELS SO RIGHT TO BE HERE WITH YOU, OH
AND NOW LOOKING IN YOUR EYES I FEEL IN MY HEART
THE START OF SOMETHING…

New. It's a pairs audition.

(They both grin at each other, and run off-stage)

[East High music room]

(Kelsi plays accompaniment while Gabriella and Troy practice their pairs audition. Sharpay and Ryan are walking around outside in the hallway and notice the singing)

GABRIELLA
WE'RE SOARING

TROY
FLYING

GABRIELLA, TROY
THERE'S NOT A STAR IN HEAVEN THAT WE CAN'T REACH

TROY
IF WE'RE TRYING

GABRIELLA, TROY
YEAH WE'RE BREAKING FREE

TROY
OH WE'RE BREAKING FREE

RYAN
Wow… they sound good.

(Sharpay listens more closely, flustered)

TROY
CAN YOU FEEL IT BUILDING?
LIKE A WAVE THE OCEAN JUST CAN'T CONTROL

GABRIELLA
CONNECTED BY A FEELING
OH IN OUR VERY SOULS

SHARPAY
(rushing back to Ryan, trying to control her anxiety. Gabriella, Troy exit. Kelsi remains in the back)

We have to do something. Okay, our callback is on Thursday and the basketball game and scholastic decathlon are on Friday… Too bad all these events weren't happening on the same day… at the same time.

RYAN
Well, that wouldn't work out because Troy and Gabriella wouldn't be able to make the…

(Sharpay lifts her brow, waiting for Ryan to understand her plan)

I'm proud to call you my sister.

SHARPAY
I know.

(Sharpay waves down Ms. Darbus to converse. They talk inaudibly. Kelsi is lingering nearby, and listens in on their conversation)

MS. DARBUS
I don't want to hear any more about Troy Bolton and that Montez girl. So, if you're telling me as co-presidents of the Drama Club that changing the callbacks would be what's best for our theatre program, then I might actually agree with you.
(Ms. Darbus walks off, Ryan stares blankly and confused)

RYAN

… so, is that a yes?

(Sharpay winks dramatically and they both walk after Ms. Darbus. Sharpay practices her audition song while walking away)

SHARPAY

(singing)
Bop bop bop, bop to the top, and wipe away your inhibitions. Stomp stomp stomp, do the romp, and strut your stuff. Bop bop bop, straight to the top, going for the glory…

(Kelsi looks concerned about the conversation she just heard)

[East High, hallway]

(Kelsi stares at the bulletin board in shock. Troy, Gabriella, Taylor, Chad, and Zeke walk up to her and try to figure out what she's staring at.)

TROY

Callbacks the same time as the game?

GABRIELLA

And the scholastic decathlon.

TAYLOR

Why would they do this?

CHAD

I smell a rat named Darbus.

KELSI

Actually, I think it's two rats, neither of them named Darbus.

CHAD

… Do you know something about this *(he pauses because he doesn't know Kelsi)* … small person?

KELSI

Ms. Darbus may think that she's protecting the show, but Ryan and Sharpay are only concerned with protecting themselves.

CHAD

(angrily)
Do you know what I'm going to do to those two over-moussed show dogs?

(Zeke tries to calm Chad down and hold him back)

TROY

-- Nothing. We're not going to do anything to them. Except sing, maybe. Alright, now this is only going to happen if we all work together. Who's in?

(The group agrees, and walks off)

[East High locker room]

(Troy is getting ready for the game. Coach Bolton walks up)

COACH BOLTON
How are you feeling?

TROY
Nervous.

COACH BOLTON
Yeah, me too. Wish I could suit up and play alongside ya.

TROY
Hey, you had your turn.

(Coach Bolton chuckles and sits next to Troy)

COACH BOLTON
You know what I want from you today?

TROY
Championship.

COACH BOLTON
Well that'll come or it won't. What I want is for you to have fun. I know all about the pressure, and probably too much of it has come from me. What I really want is to see my son having the time of his life playing the game we both love. You give me that, and I will sleep with a smile on my face no matter how the score comes out.

TROY
(touched, holding back tears)

Thanks Coach… uh… Dad.

(Coach Bolton smiles and pats Troy on the back before walking out)

[East High theatre]

(Ryan follows along with Sharpay's vocal exercises for a while, backstage)

SHARPAY
Stop!

(Sharpay does a trust fall and Ryan catches her. She stands back up and puts her hands on Ryan's shoulders.)

I trust you.

RYAN
(nodding)
Energy.

(Ms. Darbus steps out. Kelsi prepares to accompany the audition)

MS. DARBUS
Casting the leads of a show is both a challenge and a responsibility. A joy and a burden. I commend you and all other young artists that hold out for the moon, the sun, and the stars. Shall we soar together? Sharpay and Ryan! *(gestures behind her to Sharpay and Ryan)*

(Ryan struts out, says his line and starts dancing)

RYAN

Mucho gusto!

(Sharpay steps out, says her line and starts dancing)

SHARPAY

Ay, que fabulosa! Quieres bailar?

RYAN

Mira me

SHARPAY

I BELIEVE IN DREAMING
AND SHOOTING FOR THE STARS

RYAN

BABY TO BE NUMBER ONE
YOU GOT TO RAISE THE BAR

SHARPAY

KICKING AND SCRATCHING
GRINDING OUT MY BEST

RYAN

ANYTHING IT TAKES TO CLIMB
THE LADDER OF SUCCESS

SHARPAY, RYAN

WORK OUR TAILS OFF EVERYDAY
AND GOTTA BUMP THE COMPETITION
BLOW THEM ALL AWAY

SHARPAY

YEAH WE'RE GONNA--

SHARPAY, RYAN

BOP, BOP, BOP, BOP TO THE TOP
SLIP AND SLIDE AND RIDE THAT RHYTHM
JUMP AND POP, HOP TILL WE DROP
AND START AGAIN

ZIP, ZAP, ZOP, FLOP LIKE A MOP
SCOOT AROUND THE CORNER

MOVE IT TO THE GROOVE TIL THE MUSIC STOPS
DO THE BOP, BOP, BOP, TO THE TOP
DON'T EVER STOP
BOP TO THE TOP
GIMME GIMME, SHIMMY SHIMMY
SHAKE SOME BOOTY AND TURN AROUND
FLASH A SMILE IN THEIR DIRECTION
SHOW SOME MUSCLE, DO THE HUSTLE

YEAH WE'RE GONNA
BOP, BOP, BOP, BOP TO THE TOP
WIPE AWAY YOUR INHIBITIONS
STOMP, STOMP, STOMP, DO THE ROMP
AND STRUT YOUR STUFF
BOP, BOP, BOP, STRAIGHT TO THE TOP
GOIN' FOR THE GLORY
WE'LL KEEP STEPPING UP AND WE JUST WON'T STOP
'TIL WE REACH THE TOP
BOP TO THE TOP

(Ms. Darbus claps enthusiastically as Sharpay and Ryan bow and exit the stage)

MS. DARBUS
Do you see why we love the theater, people? Well done. Ah, Troy Bolton, Gabriella Montez. Troy? Gabriella?

KELSI
They'll be here

MS. DARBUS
The theater, as I have often pointed out, waits for no one. I'm sorry.

(Kelsi runs off)

Well, we are done here. Congratulations to all. The cast list will be posted.

(Troy and Gabriella rush in)

TROY
No! Wait! Ms. Darbus wait! We're ready! We can sing!

MS. DARBUS
I called your names. Twice.

GABRIELLA
Ms. Darbus, please! Please!

MS. DARBUS
Rules are rules.

(The rest of the student body trickles in to the auditorium to watch the auditions. Sharpay and Ryan step back on stage behind Ms. Darbus)

SHARPAY
We'll be happy to do it again for our fellow students, Ms. Darbus.

MS. DARBUS
I don't know what's going on here, but in any event, it is far too late and we have not got a pianist.

RYAN
Well, that's show biz.

TROY
We'll sing without a piano!

KELSI

(running up to them)

Oh no, you won't. Pianist here, Ms. Darbus.

SHARPAY

(stepping in front of Ms. Darbus to confront Kelsi)

You really don't want to do that.

KELSI

Oh yes, I really do. Ready on stage!

(Sharpay is aghast, and Ryan leads her off-stage)

MS. DARBUS

Now that's show biz.

(Kelsi prepares to accompany. Troy and Gabriella are center stage. Everyone else exits)

(Troy nods at Kelsi to start playing the music and waits for Gabriella to sing her part. She stands paralyzed looking at the crowd. Kelsi stops playing and Troy goes up to Gabriella)

GABRIELLA

I can't do it, Troy. Not with all of these people staring at me.

TROY

Hey, hey, hey, look at me. Right at me. It'll be like the first time we sang together. Do you remember? Like kindergarten.

(Kelsi starts the music again while Troy and Gabriella face each other)

TROY, GABRIELLA

WE'RE SOARING, FLYING
THERE'S NOT A STAR IN HEAVEN THAT WE CAN'T REACH
IF WE'RE TRYING, SO WE'RE BREAKING FREE

TROY

YOU KNOW THE WORLD CAN SEE US
IN A WAY THAT'S DIFFERENT THAN WHO WE ARE

GABRIELLA

CREATING SPACE BETWEEN US
'TIL WE'RE SEPARATE HEARTS

TROY, GABRIELLA

BUT YOUR FAITH, IT GIVES ME STRENGTH
STRENGTH TO BELIEVE (WE'RE BREAKING FREE)

WE'RE SOARING, FLYING
THERE'S NOT A STAR IN HEAVEN THAT WE CAN'T REACH
IF WE'RE TRYING, YEAH, WE'RE BREAKING FREE
OH WE'RE BREAKING FREE, OOH

TROY

CAN YOU FEEL IT BUILDING
LIKE A WAVE THE OCEAN JUST CAN'T CONTROL

GABRIELLA

CONNECTED BY A FEELING, OH IN OUR VERY SOULS, OH

GABRIELLA, TROY

RISING 'TIL IT LIFTS US UP
SO EVERYONE CAN SEE (WE'RE BREAKING FREE)

WE'RE SOARING, FLYING
THERE'S NOT A STAR IN HEAVEN THAT WE CAN'T REACH
IF WE'RE TRYING, YEAH WE'RE BREAKING FREE
OH WE'RE BREAKING FREE, OOH
RUNNING, CLIMBING
TO GET TO THAT PLACE TO BE ALL THAT WE CAN BE
NOW'S THE TIME, SO WE'RE BREAKING FREE
WE'RE BREAKING FREE

MORE THAN HOPE, MORE THAN FAITH
THIS IS TRUE, THIS IS FATE
AND TOGETHER, WE SEE IT COMING
MORE THAN YOU, MORE THAN ME
NOT A WANT, BUT A NEED
BOTH OF US ARE BREAKING FREE

SOARING, FLYING
THERE'S NOT A STAR IN HEAVEN THAT WE CAN'T REACH
IF WE'RE TRYING
YEAH WE'RE BREAKING FREE (BREAKING FREE)
WE'RE RUNNING, CLIMBING
TO GET TO THAT PLACE TO BE ALL THAT WE CAN BE
NOW'S THE TIME (NOW'S THE TIME) SO WE'RE BREAKING FREE

YOU KNOW THE WORLD CAN SEE US
IN A WAY THAT'S DIFFERENT FROM WHO WE ARE

(Everyone cheers and comes on stage)

COACH BOLTON

I'm proud of you, son.

MS. DARBUS

Bravo!

GABRIELLA

(to Troy)

Congratulations, Wildcat.

(Troy and Gabriella hug – or kiss if willing to commit to the bit)

CHAD

(to Taylor)

So, you're going with me to the afterparty, right?

TAYLOR

Like on a date??

CHAD

Must be your lucky day.

(Taylor rushes up to Gabriella)

TAYLOR

Chad just asked me out!

(Sharpay and Ryan step up behind Gabriella)

SHARPAY

Well, congratulations. I guess I'm going to be the understudy in case you can't make one of the shows, so break a leg.

(Gabriella looks startled. Sharpay laughs.)

In theater, that means good luck.

(Sharpay and Ryan walk away from Gabriella, Zeke comes up to block their way)

ZEKE

Hey Sharpay, I'm sorry you didn't get the lead, but I think you're really good. I admire you so much.

SHARPAY

And why wouldn't you? Now buh-bye!

ZEKE

Wait! I baked you some cookies.

SHARPAY

Ew!

(Ryan takes the cookies on her behalf and the siblings exit. Troy walks up to Kelsi)

TROY

Composer, here's your game ball. You deserve it, playmaker.

CHAD

What team?

STUDENTS

Wildcats!

CHAD

What team?

STUDENTS

Wildcats!

(Last song. Thanks for making it this far c:)

ALL

TOGETHER, TOGETHER
TOGETHER, EVERYONE
TOGETHER, TOGETHER
COME ON, LET'S HAVE SOME FUN
TOGETHER, WE'RE THERE FOR
EACH OTHER EVERY TIME
TOGETHER, TOGETHER
COME ON, LET'S DO THIS RIGHT

TROY, GABRIELLA, ENSEMBLE

HERE AND NOW, IT'S TIME FOR CELEBRATION
I FINALLY FIGURED OUT, YEAH
THAT ALL OUR DREAMS HAVE NO LIMITATIONS
THAT'S WHAT IT'S ALL ABOUT (COME ON NOW)
EVERYONE IS SPECIAL IN THEIR OWN WAY
WE MAKE EACH OTHER STRONG (WE MAKE EACH OTHER STRONG)
WE'RE NOT THE SAME, WE'RE DIFFERENT IN A GOOD WAY
TOGETHER'S WHERE WE BELONG

ALL

WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
ONCE WE KNOW THAT WE ARE
WE'RE ALL STARS AND WE SEE THAT
WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
AND IT SHOWS WHEN WE STAND HAND IN HAND
MAKE OUR DREAMS COME TRUE

GABRIELLA

Everybody, now!

ALL

TOGETHER, TOGETHER
TOGETHER, EVERYONE
TOGETHER, TOGETHER
COME ON, LET'S HAVE SOME FUN
TOGETHER, WE'RE THERE FOR
EACH OTHER EVERY TIME
TOGETHER, TOGETHER
COME ON, LET'S DO THIS RIGHT

RYAN, SHARPAY, ENSEMBLE

WE'RE ALL HERE, AND SPEAKING OUT WITH ONE VOICE
WE'RE GONNA ROCK THE HOUSE (YEAH, YEAH)
THE PARTY'S ON, NOW EVERYBODY MAKE SOME NOISE
COME ON AND SCREAM AND SHOUT
WE'VE ARRIVED BECAUSE WE STUCK TOGETHER
CHAMPIONS ONE AND ALL

ALL

WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
ONCE WE KNOW THAT WE ARE
WE'RE ALL STARS AND WE SEE THAT
WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
AND IT SHOWS WHEN WE STAND HAND IN HAND
MAKE OUR DREAMS COME TRUE
WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
WHEN WE REACH, WE CAN FLY
KNOW INSIDE WE CAN MAKE IT
WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
ONCE WE SEE THERE'S A CHANCE
THAT WE HAVE AND WE TAKE IT

WILDCATS, SING ALONG
YEAH, YOU REALLY GOT IT GOIN' ON
WILDCATS, IN THE HOUSE
EVERYBODY, SAY IT NOW
WILDCATS, EVERYWHERE
WAVE YOUR HANDS UP IN THE AIR
THAT'S THE WAY WE DO IT, LET'S GET TO IT
TIME TO SHOW THE WORLD

(Pairs to come center stage and bow for their performance)
(Zeke and Kelsi)
(Ms. Darbus and Coach Bolton)
(Chad and Taylor)
(Sharpay and Ryan)
(Gabriella and Troy)
(Rest of the cast, including show runner)

ALL

WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
ONCE WE KNOW THAT WE ARE
WE'RE ALL STARS AND WE SEE THAT
WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
AND IT SHOWS WHEN WE STAND HAND IN HAND
MAKE OUR DREAMS COME TRUE
WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
WHEN WE REACH, WE CAN FLY
KNOW INSIDE WE CAN MAKE IT
WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER
ONCE WE SEE THERE'S A CHANCE
THAT WE HAVE AND WE TAKE IT

WILDCATS, EVERYWHERE
WAVE YOUR HANDS UP IN THE AIR
THAT'S THE WAY WE DO IT, LET'S GET TO IT
COME ON, EVERYONE

[fin]